Marriott Personalization Strategy

AI-Driven Trip Intent Orchestration: A Roadmap to Enhanced Guest Experience & Revenue Growth

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Executive Summary: Marriott Personalization Strategy

Business Context

- 30+ global brands with high fixed costs
- Bonvoy loyalty program as core 1P asset
- Critical focus on RevPAR & Lifetime Value

Key Impact Metrics

Booking Conversion	Avg. Booking Value
Ancillary Attach Rate	Retention & CLV

Maturity Assessment

Overall Score: **2.3 / 5**

Strengths: Loyalty identity in app, preference collection, milestone triggers

Gaps: Member vs non-member experience identical on web. No search personalization, no behavioral triggers, no cross-channel orchestration

Strategic Opportunity

AI-Driven Trip Intent Orchestration

- Infer trip purpose (Business vs Leisure)
- Dynamically adapt experience & offers
- Sequence actions across customer lifecycle

Recommended Initial Test (MVP)

Personalized Search & Homepage
Rank hotels based on inferred intent

Context-Relevant Bundles
Surface packages matching trip type

Behavior-Based Upsells
Trigger relevant add-ons dynamically

Success Metrics

- Improvement in Conversion Rate
- Increase in Revenue per Session

Marriott Personalization Framework

Know Me

Unified traveler identity for lifetime value optimization

- Customer 360 across brands
- Loyalty tier & tenure
- Booking frequency & patterns
- CLV & churn modeling

Impact: Improve retention & targeted investment

Reach Me

Context-aware communications at the right moment

- Trigger-based lifecycle messages
- Event & geo-targeted outreach
- Rebooking nudges
- Abandoned search follow-up

Impact: Increase engagement & reactivation

Show Me

Adapt digital experience based on inferred intent

- Dynamic homepage personalization
- Contextual hotel ranking
- Personalized bundles
- Weather-aware recommendations

Impact: Increase booking conversion & AOV

Empower Me

Orchestrate next-best-action across channels

- Sequenced upgrade nudges
- Dynamic offer prioritization
- Multi-armed bandit testing
- Loyalty milestone progression

Impact: Maximize revenue per traveler

Delight Me

Enhance experience to drive loyalty

- Personalized pre-arrival welcome
- AI concierge support
- Surprise-and-delight rewards
- Post-stay rebooking journey

Impact: Increase CLV & advocacy

High-Value Personalization Use Cases by Framework Bucket

Know Me
Identity & Intelligence

- Unified Customer 360 profile
- Trip-purpose prediction (Biz/Leisure)
- Corporate traveler detection
- CLV scoring & prioritization
- Churn risk prediction model
- Frequency clustering (Road warrior)
- Elite upgrade probability scoring

Reach Me
Contextual Activation

- Abandoned search follow-up
- Geo-targeted event targeting
- Birthday/anniversary offers
- Weather-based trip inspiration
- Predictive reactivation campaigns
- Push notification timing opt
- Stay anniversary rebooking nudges

Show Me
Dynamic Experience

- Dynamic homepage hero
- Contextual hotel ranking
- Stay-length package bundling
- Flexible cancellation emphasis
- Resort/spa emphasis (Weekend)
- AI-powered itinerary builder
- Real-time urgency messaging

Empower Me
Orchestration & NBA

- Sequenced upgrade nudges
- Multi-armed bandit offer testing
- Dynamic loyalty milestone prompts
- Cross-brand migration targeting
- Tier-progression acceleration
- Personalized redemption suggestions
- Reactivation journey automation

Delight Me
On-Property & Post-Stay

- Personalized pre-arrival message
- Targeted dining/spa upsell
- Late checkout personalization
- AI concierge chat assistant
- Elite surprise-and-delight rewards
- Post-stay “rebook similar” prompt
- Gamified frequency challenges

Detailed Assessment — Know Me (Customer Identity & Intelligence)

Objective: Build unified traveler identity to power personalization and lifetime value optimization.

Use Case	Performance	Score	Explanation
Loyalty Tier Recognition	Strong	4	App shows "Hi Jonah," Gold Elite, 16,403 pts. Mobile web shows none of this despite being logged in.
Saved Preferences	Moderate	3	Account page lists Food & Beverage, Interests, and Room Preferences sections, but none surfaced in search
Cross-Brand Identity	Moderate	3	Bonvoy unifies brands, but no cross-brand insights. citizenM acquisition members received Gold status with no onboarding or preference migration.
Trip-Purpose Modeling	Limited	2	NYC weekday 1-night and Napa weekend 2-night searches returned identical result formats. No intent adaptation.
CLV-Based Targeting	Not Visible	2	Gold Elite member sees identical search results and homepage as a non-member. No differentiated treatment.
Churn Prediction	Not Visible	1	Only one email received in months: a generic 100-day milestone. No targeted win-back or re-engagement.
Channel Preference	Limited	2	No SMS received. Only one lifecycle email in months. No channel optimization visible.
Upgrade Probability	Moderate	3	Credit card upsell shown on both app and profile page, but not contextual to booking behavior.

Overall Assessment

Strength: Strong deterministic identity via loyalty program.

Gap: Identity data collected (preferences, tier, points) but not activated. Gold Elite member experience identical to non-member on web.

Know Me Maturity Score

2.5 / 5

Foundation in place. Predictive intelligence under-leveraged.

Detailed Assessment — Reach Me (Activation & Targeting Intelligence)

Objective: Deliver the right message at the right moment across web, app, email, and SMS.

Use Case	Performance	Score	Explanation
Abandoned Search Follow-Up	Limited	2	Searched NYC and Napa on mobile web. No follow-up email, push, or SMS triggered within observation window.
Destination-Based Email Targeting	Moderate	3	Only email received was a 100-day milestone. No destination-specific or search-triggered messaging observed.
Geo/Event-Based Targeting	Limited	2	Mobile web homepage showed Coachella promo, but this was identical for all users, not geo-targeted.
Weather-Based Messaging	Not Visible	1	No evidence of weather-driven personalization in email or app.
Predictive Reactivation	Limited	2	Gold member with 0 nights stayed received no reactivation outreach. Only a generic milestone email.
Push Notification Timing Optimization	Limited	2	No push notifications received after app browse or web search activity.
Lifecycle Trigger Journeys	Moderate	3	100-day milestone email received with onboarding checklist. No other lifecycle triggers observed.
Channel Preference Modeling	Limited	2	No SMS received at all. Email volume extremely low. No evidence of channel testing or optimization.

Overall Assessment

Strength: Strong transactional journey (confirmation, pre-arrival, post-stay survey).

Gap: Activation severely underdeveloped. Gold member with 0 nights received one generic email in months. No behavioral triggers, no search retargeting, no SMS, no push notifications observed.

Reach Me Maturity Score

2.1 / 5

Solid messaging infrastructure. Underdeveloped targeting intelligence.

Detailed Assessment — Show Me (Dynamic Experience Personalization)

Objective: Adapt digital experience and content dynamically based on traveler intent and behavior.

Use Case	Performance	Score	Explanation
Dynamic Homepage Hero	Limited	2	Mobile web shows generic Coachella promo when logged in. App shows "Breakfast for Two" hero, not tailored to search history.
Contextual Hotel Ranking	Limited	2	Both NYC and Napa searches default to "Sort by: Distance." Gold member results identical to non-member.
Stay-Length-Based Bundling	Moderate	3	No visible packages or bundles in search results for either NYC or Napa. Packages not surfaced contextually.
Business vs Leisure Experience Mode	Not Visible	1	Weekday 1-night NYC and weekend 2-night Napa produced identical UX. No trip mode differentiation.
Room-Type Personalization	Moderate	3	Account stores Room Preferences but search results show no preference-based ranking or filtering.
Event-Based Property Surfacing	Limited	2	Coachella promo on homepage but not connected to search. No event-aware property surfacing in results.
Real-Time Urgency Messaging	Moderate	3	No urgency messaging observed in NYC or Napa search results.
Personalized Cancellation Messaging	Limited	2	No cancellation policy emphasis observed in search results for weekday or weekend stays.

Overall Assessment

Strength: App has "Recently Viewed" section and basic identity. Preference collection exists in account settings.

Gap: Search and browse experience is completely static. Member vs non-member results are identical. No intent, preference, or behavioral signals used in ranking.

Show Me Maturity Score

2.3 / 5

Personalization components exist. Dynamic orchestration layer not visible.

Detailed Assessment — Empower Me (Orchestration & Next Best Action)

Objective: Prioritize and sequence interactions dynamically across channels to maximize traveler value.

Use Case	Performance	Score	Explanation
Next Best Action Engine	Not Visible	1	No evidence of dynamic sequencing across booking lifecycle.
Cross-Channel Orchestration	Limited	2	App shows "Recently Viewed" but web does not reflect app activity. No cross-channel continuity observed.
Sequenced Upgrade Nudges	Limited	2	Credit card upsell appears on app home and profile regardless of context. Not triggered by booking behavior.
Dynamic Offer Prioritization	Limited	2	App shows credit card offer + breakfast promo simultaneously. No visible prioritization by user profile or behavior.
Multi-Armed Bandit Testing	Not Visible	1	No evidence of adaptive experimentation at user level.
Cross-Brand Migration Targeting	Limited	2	Brand suggestions exist but not clearly predictive (e.g., Courtyard → Westin).
Loyalty Milestone Sequencing	Moderate	3	100-day milestone email triggered, but checklist showed incomplete actions with no follow-up nudges.
Reactivation Journey Automation	Limited	2	Gold member with 0 nights stayed has not received any reactivation campaign or incentive to book.

Overall Assessment

Strength: Loyalty infrastructure supports sequencing. Brand ecosystem creates opportunity for orchestration.

Gap: No orchestration layer visible. Channels operate independently. A Gold member with 0 stays receives no sequenced engagement to drive first booking.

Empower Me Maturity Score

1.9 / 5

Data foundation strong. Orchestration intelligence underdeveloped.

Detailed Assessment — Delight Me (On-Property & Loyalty Expansion)

Objective: Enhance on-property and post-stay experience to increase retention, advocacy, and lifetime value.

Use Case	Performance	Score	Explanation
Pre-Arrival Personalized Welcome	Moderate	3	No stays completed, so no pre-arrival experience to assess. 100-day email was generic, not behavior-driven.
Targeted Dining/Spa Upsell	Limited	2	Upsells available but not clearly tailored to past ancillary spend.
Late Checkout Personalization	Moderate	3	Elite members eligible, but not dynamically surfaced by trip pattern.
AI Concierge / In-App Assistance	Limited	2	App has basic service features (Book, Trips, Wishlists) but no proactive AI concierge or recommendations.
Surprise-and-Delight Rewards	Moderate	3	Gold status acknowledged in app but no surprise perks, personalized offers, or recognition beyond tier display.
Personalized Service Recovery	Limited	2	Post-stay surveys present; unclear if recovery is ML-prioritized.
Post-Stay Rebooking Prompts	Moderate	3	No rebooking prompts observed. App shows "Recently Viewed" but no proactive rebooking suggestions.
Gamified Loyalty Challenges	Limited	2	100-day email included a checklist but no gamification, challenges, or frequency incentives observed.

Overall Assessment

Strength: Strong loyalty infrastructure enables recognition. Elite program provides foundation for delight moments.

Gap: Post-acquisition member (citizenM) with 0 stays received minimal engagement. No personalized onboarding, no surprise-and-delight, no incentive to complete first Marriott booking.

Delight Me Maturity Score

2.5 / 5

Experience personalization present but not predictive or fully individualized.

Prioritized Use Case: AI-Powered Trip Intent Orchestration Engine

Selected Use Case: Intent Engine

Trip Intent Orchestration (Business vs Leisure)

- Infer intent via ML to adapt Homepage & Search
- Dynamic Bundled Offers & Upgrade Sequencing
- Pre-arrival Upsell Optimization

Test Design: A/B/C Experiment

Groups: Control (Static), Variant A (Business), Variant B (Leisure)

Key KPIs:

- Booking Conversion & Rev/Session
- Package Attach Rate & Repeat Booking

01. Addresses Largest Gap

Targeting the lowest maturity area:
Empower Me (1.9/5)

Marriott currently lacks visible "Next Best Action" sequencing, a critical pain point in the customer journey.

02. High Revenue Leverage

Impacts conversion, AOV, and ancillary attach rate.

Assumptions: 8M bookings, 5% lift
Incremental Revenue:
$28–30M / Year

03. Technically Feasible

Data Ready: Loyalty, booking history, clickstream.

Required Additions: Trip-type classifier, real-time engine, experimentation layer. Infrastructure is largely in place.

04. Strategic Differentiation

Competitive Edge: Outperform Hilton/Hyatt/Airbnb.

Leverage Marriott's deep brand portfolio and rich loyalty data to create a context-driven experience unmatched by peers.

Mockup — Trip Intent Orchestration MVP

BEFORE: Current Experience

- Static hero banner, no personalization
- Generic package options for all users
- Rule-based sorting (price/distance)
- No differentiation between weekday vs weekend search

Summary: Experience is rigid and not intent-adaptive.

AFTER: Business Mode

- "Welcome back. Traveling for work?"
- Executive lounge & flexible cancellation prioritized
- Corporate rate auto-applied
- 1-night optimized hotels prioritized

CTA: "Add Meeting Room Access?"

AFTER: Leisure Mode

- "Weekend getaway in Napa?"
- Resort & spa properties ranked higher
- 2-3 night bundle packages & dining credits
- Balcony / view rooms emphasized
- Dining credit add-ons highlighted

CTA: "Create Personalized Weekend Itinerary"

Data Inputs Required

Loyalty Tier	Historical stay day-of-week pattern	Stay Duration History	Corporate email domain
Ancillary spend category	Room preference history	Clickstream signals	Search timestamp

KPIs for Test

- Conversion Rate & Revenue per Session
- Package Attach Rate & Upgrade Purchase Rate
- 90-day Repeat Booking & CLV Lift

System Architecture Flow

Customer 360

Trip Intent ML Model → Orchestration Engine

CMS / App Rendering Layer → Experimentation Platform → Measurement Dashboard